

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12413059
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
Inventor(s)	Seubert; Matthew

Outlet cover having a shelf

Abstract

An outlet cover, including a cover plate removably connected to at least one electrical outlet and surrounding the at least one electrical outlet, and at least one shelf disposed on at least a portion of the cover plate to receive at least one of a plug and a mobile device thereon.

Inventors:	Seubert; Matthew (Shelby, MT)
Applicant:	Seubert; Matthew (Shelby, MT)
Family ID:	94175161
Appl. No.:	18/217860
Filed:	July 03, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20250015577 A1	Jan. 09, 2025

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H02G3/14 (20060101); H02J7/00 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H02G3/14 (20130101); H02J7/0044 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H02G (3/14); H02J (7/0044)

USPC: 174/66

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
3113996	12/1962	Sanford	174/67	H01R 13/60
7812257	12/2009	Gunderman	174/67	H02G 3/14
8864517	12/2013	Cohen	439/652	H02M 7/08
9065263	12/2014	Porcano	N/A	H01R 13/447
11456585	12/2021	Baldwin	N/A	G06F 1/1632
2011/0129722	12/2010	Yoneda	29/623.2	H01M 50/417
2011/0132634	12/2010	Fetzer-Westmeister	174/66	H02G 3/14

Primary Examiner: Thompson; Timothy J

Assistant Examiner: McAllister; Michael F

Attorney, Agent or Firm: The Iwashko Law Firm, PLLC

Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

1. Field

(1) The present general inventive concept relates generally to an outlet cover, and particularly, to an outlet cover having a shelf.

2. Description of the Related Art

(2) An electrical outlet or socket are used as a connector on a piece of equipment and/or a building. Generally, the electrical outlet is used to connect to a plug that is a part of an electrical device. As such, the electrical device can receive power from the electrical outlet while the plug is connected into the electrical outlet.

(3) However, the connection between the plug and/or the electrical outlet is often not secure. The plug, such as a cell phone charger, is prone to falling out either on its own and/or after being jostled by a person and/or an animal. Despite carefully securing a plug in an outlet, many times individuals will find out that the plug falls out minutes after the fact. Aside from being incredibly inconvenient, an unsteady plug can also cause an electrical hazard.

(4) Therefore, there is a need for an outlet cover having a shelf to ensure the plug remains connected to the electrical outlet.

SUMMARY

(5) The present general inventive concept provides an outlet cover having a shelf.

(6) Additional features and utilities of the present general inventive concept will be set forth in part in the description which follows and, in part, will be obvious from the description, or may be learned by practice of the general inventive concept.

(7) The foregoing and/or other features and utilities of the present general inventive concept may be achieved by providing an outlet cover, including a cover plate removably connected to at least one electrical outlet and surrounding the at least one electrical outlet, and at least one shelf disposed on at least a portion of the cover plate to receive at least one of a plug and a mobile device thereon.

(8) The at least one shelf may include a support surface movably disposed on at least a portion of the cover plate to receive at least one of the plug and the mobile device thereon, and a movable

wall be movably disposed on at least a portion of the support surface to move from retracted against the support surface in a first position to extended away from the support surface in a second position, and move from extended away from the support surface in the second position to retracted against the support surface in the first position, such that the movable wall prevents movement of at least one of the plug and the mobile device while the movable wall is extended.

(9) The at least one shelf may further include a first support bracket movably disposed at a first end of the support surface to support the first end of the support surface while the support surface is extended, and a second support bracket movable disposed at a second end of the support surface to support the second end of the support surface while the support surface is extended.

(10) The first support bracket and the second support bracket may extend the support surface away from the cover plate using a spring in response to depressing the support surface while the support surface is retracted against the cover plate.

(11) The support surface may have an adhesive substrate disposed thereon to prevent movement of at least one of the plug and the mobile device off the support surface.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) These and/or other features and utilities of the present generally inventive concept will become apparent and more readily appreciated from the following description of the embodiments, taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings of which:

(2) FIG. 1A illustrates a side perspective view of an outlet cover with a shelf in an extended position, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present general inventive concept;

(3) FIG. 1B illustrates a side perspective view of the outlet cover with the shelf in a retracted position, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present general inventive concept; and

(4) FIG. 2 illustrates a front perspective view of the outlet cover, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present general inventive concept.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(5) Various example embodiments (a.k.a., exemplary embodiments) will now be described more fully with reference to the accompanying drawings in which some example embodiments are illustrated. In the figures, the thicknesses of lines, layers and/or regions may be exaggerated for clarity.

(6) Accordingly, while example embodiments are capable of various modifications and alternative forms, embodiments thereof are shown by way of example in the figures and will herein be described in detail. It should be understood, however, that there is no intent to limit example embodiments to the particular forms disclosed, but on the contrary, example embodiments are to cover all modifications, equivalents, and alternatives falling within the scope of the disclosure. Like numbers refer to like/similar elements throughout the detailed description.

(7) It is understood that when an element is referred to as being “connected” or “coupled” to another element, it can be directly connected or coupled to the other element or intervening elements may be present. In contrast, when an element is referred to as being “directly connected” or “directly coupled” to another element, there are no intervening elements present. Other words used to describe the relationship between elements should be interpreted in a like fashion (e.g., “between” versus “directly between,” “adjacent” versus “directly adjacent,” etc.).

(8) The terminology used herein is for the purpose of describing particular embodiments only and is not intended to be limiting of example embodiments. As used herein, the singular forms “a,” “an” and “the” are intended to include the plural forms as well, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. It will be further understood that the terms “comprises,” “comprising,” “includes” and/or “including,” when used herein, specify the presence of stated features, integers, steps,

operations, elements and/or components, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, integers, steps, operations, elements, components and/or groups thereof.

(9) Unless otherwise defined, all terms (including technical and scientific terms) used herein have the same meaning as commonly understood by one of ordinary skill in the art to which example embodiments belong. It will be further understood that terms, e.g., those defined in commonly used dictionaries, should be interpreted as having a meaning that is consistent with their meaning in the context of the relevant art. However, should the present disclosure give a specific meaning to a term deviating from a meaning commonly understood by one of ordinary skill, this meaning is to be taken into account in the specific context this definition is given herein.

LIST OF COMPONENTS

(10) Outlet Cover **100** Cover Plate **110** Shelf **120** Support Surface **121** Adhesive Substrate **121a** Movable Wall **122** Hinge **123** First Support Bracket **124** First Spring **124a** Second Support Bracket **125** Second Spring **125a**

(11) FIG. 1A illustrates a side perspective view of an outlet cover **100** with a shelf **120** in an extended position, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present general inventive concept.

(12) FIG. 1B illustrates a side perspective view of the outlet cover **100** with the shelf **120** in a retracted position, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present general inventive concept.

(13) The outlet cover **100** may be constructed from at least one of metal, plastic, wood, and rubber, etc., but is not limited thereto.

(14) The outlet cover **100** may include a cover plate **110** and at least one shelf **120**, but is not limited thereto.

(15) The cover plate **110** may be designed to removably cover and/or surround at least one electrical outlet **10** (i.e., socket) on a wall and/or an object. For example, the cover plate **110** may cover two electrical outlets **10**, three electrical outlets **10**, and/or four electrical outlets **10**. In other words, the cover plate **110** may be constructed and/or configured to cover any number of electrical outlets **10**. Moreover, the cover plate **110** may obstruct and/or prevent access to electrical wiring and/or circuitry connected to the at least one electrical outlet **10** to prevent injury to a user.

(16) The at least one shelf **120** may include a support surface **121**, a movable wall **122**, a hinge **123**, a first support bracket **124**, and a second support bracket **125**, but is not limited thereto.

(17) The support surface **121** may be movably (i.e., pivotally, rotatably) disposed on at least a portion of the cover plate **110**. Referring to FIGS. 1A and 1B, the support surface **121** may move from retracted against the cover plate **110** in a first position to extended away from the cover plate **110** in a second position. The support surface **121** may be disposed in parallel with the cover plate **110** in the first position and/or angularly (e.g., perpendicularly) disposed away from the cover plate **110** in the second position. Conversely, the support surface **121** may move from extended away from the cover plate **110** in the second position to retracted against the cover plate **110** in the first position.

(18) The support surface **121** may receive a plug thereon. More specifically, the support surface **121** may hold and/or support the plug while the plug is inserted into the at least one electrical outlet **10**. As such, the support surface **121** may prevent the plug from falling out of the at least one electrical outlet **10**.

(19) Alternatively, and/or in addition thereto, the support surface **121** may receive a mobile device, such as a cell phone, a smart phone, a tablet computer, thereon. Thus, the support surface **121** may be used to facilitate charging of the mobile device while the mobile device is connected via a plug to the at least one electrical outlet **10**.

(20) Furthermore, the support surface **121** may have an adhesive substrate **121a** (e.g., tape, glue) disposed thereon. The adhesive substrate may increase a resistance level of movement of the plug, such that the plug and/or the mobile device is prevented from sliding off the support surface **121**.

(21) The movable wall **122** may be movably (i.e., pivotally, rotatably) disposed on at least a portion of the support surface **121**. Referring again to FIGS. 1A and 1B, the movable wall **122** may move

from retracted against the support surface **121** in a first position to extended away from the support surface **121** in a second position. The movable wall **122** may be disposed in parallel with the support surface **121** in the first position and/or angularly (e.g., perpendicularly) disposed away from the support surface **121** in the second position. Conversely, the movable wall **122** may move from extended away from the support surface **121** in the second position to retracted against the support surface **121** in the first position.

(22) The movable wall **122** may prevent lateral movement of the plug and/or the mobile device on the support surface **121** while the plug is inserted into the at least one electrical outlet **10** and/or disposed on the support surface **121** in response to the movable wall **122** being in the extended position. In other words, the movable wall **122** may form a barrier to obstruct movement of the plug.

(23) The hinge **123** may be disposed between the support surface **121** and/or the movable wall **122**. The hinge **123** may facilitate movement of the movable wall **122** with respect to the support surface **121**.

(24) The first support bracket **124** may be movably (i.e., slidably) disposed at a first end of the support surface **121**. The first support bracket **124** may move from retracted against the cover plate **110** in a first position to extended away from the cover plate **110** in a second position. Conversely, the first support bracket **124** may move from extended away from the cover plate **110** in the second position to retracted against the cover plate **110** in the first position.

(25) The second support bracket **125** may be movably (i.e., slidably) disposed at a second end of the support surface **121** opposite with respect to the first end. The second support bracket **125** may move from retracted against the cover plate **110** in a first position to extended away from the cover plate **110** in a second position. Conversely, the second support bracket **125** may move from extended away from the cover plate **110** in the second position to retracted against the cover plate **110** in the first position.

(26) Alternatively, and/or in addition thereto, the first support bracket **124** and/or the second support bracket **125** may be springingly disposed on the support surface **121**, such that a first spring **124a** and/or a second spring **125a** may be triggered in response to depressing the first support surface **121** a first time toward the cover plate **110**, such that the first support surface **121**, the first support bracket **124** and/or the second support bracket **125** are extended away from the cover plate **110**. After use, the first support surface **121**, the first support bracket **124**, and/or the second support bracket **125** may be depressed a second time toward the cover plate **110** to be locked against the cover plate **110** during storage.

(27) Collectively, the first support bracket **124** and/or the second support bracket **125** may support the support surface **121** while the support surface **121** is extended (e.g., fully extended) away from the cover plate **110**. Moreover, the first support bracket **124** and/or the second support bracket **125** may collapse and/or fold to allow the support surface **121** to retract against the cover plate **110** during storage.

(28) FIG. 2 illustrates a front perspective view of the outlet cover **100**, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present general inventive concept.

(29) Referring to FIG. 2, the at least one shelf **120** may be disposed on the cover plate **110** adjacent to each electrical outlet **10**.

(30) Therefore, the outlet cover **100** may allow the mobile device and/or the plug to be stored on the at least one shelf **120** while connected to the at least one electrical outlet **10**. Also, the at least one shelf **120** may prevent the plug from moving away from the at least one electrical outlet **10**.

(31) The present general inventive concept may include an outlet cover **100**, including a cover plate **110** removably connected to at least one electrical outlet **10** and surrounding the at least one electrical outlet **10**, and at least one shelf **120** disposed on at least a portion of the cover plate **110** to receive at least one of a plug and a mobile device thereon.

(32) The at least one shelf **120** may include a support surface **121** movably disposed on at least a

portion of the cover plate **110** to receive at least one of the plug and the mobile device thereon, and a movable wall **122** be movably disposed on at least a portion of the support surface **121** to move from retracted against the support surface **121** in a first position to extended away from the support surface **121** in a second position, and move from extended away from the support surface **121** in the second position to retracted against the support surface **121** in the first position, such that the movable wall **122** prevents movement of at least one of the plug and the mobile device while the movable wall **122** is extended.

(33) The at least one shelf **120** may further include a first support bracket **124** movably disposed at a first end of the support surface **121** to support the first end of the support surface **121** while the support surface **121** is extended, and a second support bracket **125** movable disposed at a second end of the support surface **121** to support the second end of the support surface **121** while the support surface **121** is extended.

(34) The first support bracket **124** and the second support bracket **125** may extend the support surface **121** away from the cover plate **110** using a spring in response to depressing the support surface **121** while the support surface **121** is retracted against the cover plate **110**.

(35) The support surface **121** may have an adhesive substrate disposed thereon to prevent movement of at least one of the plug and the mobile device off the support surface **121**.

(36) Although a few embodiments of the present general inventive concept have been shown and described, it will be appreciated by those skilled in the art that changes may be made in these embodiments without departing from the principles and spirit of the general inventive concept, the scope of which is defined in the appended claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. An outlet cover, comprising: a cover plate removably connected to at least one electrical outlet and surrounding the at least one electrical outlet; and at least one shelf disposed on at least a portion of the cover plate to receive at least one of a plug and a mobile device thereon, wherein the at least one shelf comprises: a support surface movably disposed on at least a portion of the cover plate to receive at least one of the plug and the mobile device thereon, and a movable wall be movably disposed on at least a portion of the support surface to move from retracted against the support surface in a first position to extended away from the support surface in a second position, and move from extended away from the support surface in the second position to retracted against the support surface in the first position, such that the movable wall prevents movement of at least one of the plug and the mobile device while the movable wall is extended.
 2. The outlet cover of claim 1, wherein the at least one shelf further comprises: a first support bracket movably disposed at a first end of the support surface to support the first end of the support surface while the support surface is extended; and a second support bracket movable disposed at a second end of the support surface to support the second end of the support surface while the support surface is extended.
 3. The outlet cover of claim 2, wherein the first support bracket and the second support bracket extend the support surface away from the cover plate using a spring in response to depressing the support surface while the support surface is retracted against the cover plate.
 4. The outlet cover of claim 1, wherein the support surface has an adhesive substrate disposed thereon to prevent movement of at least one of the plug and the mobile device off the support surface.
-